Community service time - operating guide

CURRENT 2026; effective 1 August 2026

Scope: People advisers and approved volunteering arrangements. This is fictional Meridian Works guidance. The following responsibilities apply only to the named activity, not to other procedures with similar labels.

Volunteering during a scheduled shift counts as community service only after a community-service approval is recorded.

VOL-125 requests a school mentoring session; VOL-152 requests a weekend fundraising event.

The coordinator records what actually happened, identifies the responsible owner and checks the applicable route. A similarly numbered form is not interchangeable with the recorded form. For a rejected submission, retain the original request and obtain corrected evidence rather than creating a replacement event.

Registry VOL-226: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry VOL-237: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry VOL-248: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry VOL-259: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

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Eligibility and operational limits. Select the named cohort and activity before applying a period or amount; different entitlements in this section are not substitutes.

Permanent staff receive twelve paid volunteering hours annually; agency workers receive four paid hours.

A school mentoring absence should be requested thirteen calendar days before the scheduled visit.

A valid request contains its underlying event date and the scope used for the calculation. Reviewers distinguish acknowledgement, completion and storage periods. A deadline for submitting evidence is not a service restoration promise. If the activity or group is not stated, escalate the question rather than borrowing a nearby rule.

Registry VOL-270: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry VOL-281: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry VOL-292: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry VOL-303: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

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Document control: this 2026 operating guide is CURRENT and effective from 1 August 2026. The 2024 edition is archived and superseded. No forecast for a later year is stated.

The community service policy effective in 2026 gives permanent staff twelve paid volunteering hours annually.

Permission to use work time does not create a travel allowance; the community travel annex controls reimbursements.

The reference annex has its own scope. Staff should distinguish operational permission from commercial price, evidence retention and service specifications. Publication of a code or a process owner does not create a missing technical limit or a financial guarantee.

Amendment log: this edition consolidates the current timing rule and ownership path. Historical examples remain in the archive for traceability. They are not exceptions to the current rule. A request citing an older edition must be checked against the effective document before execution.